Zak Killermann

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PRODUCT MANAGER | IDENTITY, GROWTH & SCALABLE SYSTEMS

Product Manager with 5+ years of experience building high-leverage product surfaces across identity, growth, and monetization systems. Currently leading strategy for authentication and account lifecycle infrastructure impacting core user activation and retention. Proven track record of driving measurable business impact, including $30K+/month in incremental revenue and $200K+/month in cost savings, while partnering closely with Engineering, Design, Data, Security, and Legal to ship scalable, compliant systems.

KEY COMPETENCIES

Product Leadership:
- Roadmapping
- Cross-Functional Execution
- KPI Definition
- Stakeholder Alignment
- Workflow Automation

Technical & Data:
- Identity & Auth Systems
- APIs & Data Integrations
- Programmatic Systems
- SQL (working knowledge)
- Structured Data & Schema

Growth & Monetization:
- Activation & Retention Optimization
- A/B Testing
- Revenue Systems
- Funnel Analysis

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product Manager, User Foundations — Dec 2024 - Present
Quizlet.com | Denver, CO

Own the identity and authentication surface that gates all downstream user engagement across web and mobile.
- Set roadmap for signup, login, recovery, and account controls, directly impacting activation, retention, and platform trust
- Improved authentication reliability and reduced friction across critical login flows through UX and performance optimizations
- Increased lifecycle conversion through iterative A/B testing on signup and recovery flows
- Built KPI and experimentation frameworks measuring conversion rate, login success rate, recovery completion, and downstream retention
- Partner closely with Engineering, Security, and Legal to design compliant, scalable identity systems

Search Engine Optimization Analyst — **Jun 2024 - Dec 2024**
- Owned long-form SEO strategy for Expert Solutions content, launching programmatic optimization tools across hundreds of thousands of pages and driving scalable growth in high-intent organic traffic

Technical Publisher, Global Financial Silos — Dec 2021 - Dec 2023
Finder.com, global fintech comparison site

Led technical product initiatives across Crypto, Stock Trading, and Money Transfers verticals in collaboration with distributed global teams.
- Built a geofencing monetization system capturing ~$30K/month in incremental US revenue from previously unmonetized global traffic
- Co-led launch of large-scale programmatic “How To” series powered by automated multi-source data integrations; became top revenue drivers within their silos
- Reduced infrastructure and processing costs by ~$200K/month on average through server optimization and workflow automation
- Designed scalable internal tooling and data integrations (APIs, structured data pipelines) enabling editorial scale without proportional headcount growth
- Consolidated overlapping tools and processes, reducing maintenance overhead and improving global operational alignment
- Managed distributed reports and mentored cross-functional peers, increasing technical fluency across publishing teams

Associate Product Manager & Staff Writer — **Oct 2019 - Dec 2021**

Contributed to cross-functional product and publishing initiatives across global financial verticals while collaborating across global editorial teams to maintain quality, accuracy, and consistency.

References available upon request or at zakkillermann.com/references